said.

“Yes. It’s all right.” Rose gave her a small smile. “We’re going to be fine.”

“Promise me that you’ll stay with Virginie and Paulette, no matter what happens.”

“Here’s the row,” Rose said, checking Léa’s ticket. “Your seat is next to the window. I’m on the aisle.”

“Your— What are you talking about?”

Rose squared her shoulders. “I’m coming with you.”

A whistle blew. Léa’s heart knotted. What was happening? “Rose, get off the train.”

“I won’t. It’s not fair that I should be free while you’re not.”

“Rose, you’re wrong. I’ll be fine. Please get off.” Léa caught the German soldier’s gaze on her and realized she was shouting.

“I’ve signed the contract. I’m as committed as you are.” Rose said. “Nothing you can do now.”

Léa could see it in front of her like the pieces of a puzzle coming together. Rose had been away these last days because she’d been completing the forms for the official at the German Employment Office, instructing him to allocate their signing bonuses to Virginie. That was why Maître Mallon wouldn’t allow her to think it over for one more night, because Rose would have gone on to Germany on her own. Why hadn’t he said anything?

The train jerked backward, then forward.

“Tell them you’ve changed your mind,” Léa said. “Quickly, please. Just do it for me— go on, Rose. Please.”

“You’re all I have in this world. I couldn’t face you leaving for Germany on your own. I helped you smuggle the wine. I should have been arrested with you. We’re in this together.” Despite the tears running down both their faces, Léa could see that Rose was adamant.

As the train picked up speed, Léa clutched the top of the seat to steady herself. Passengers waved from the platform, where Rose should be now, waving goodbye.

“We will look after each other, like always,” Rose said.

Léa gritted her teeth, hands balled tight at her sides. How could her sister be so reckless? All she wanted was for Rose to be safe, and now she